

theFlow!

Quick Reference — v0.1.0

Python · PyQt6 · Cross-platform desktop canvas

What Is theFlow!

theFlow! is a cross-platform desktop application for organising images, video, audio, documents, and text in a freeform infinite canvas. Content lives in nodes connected by Bézier curves — a visual workspace closer to a mood board than a file manager. Written in Python + PyQt6. Distributed as a self-contained native binary — no Python required on end-user machines.

Node Types

Node	Key	What It Does	Inline Viewer
Text	T	Rich text with bold/italic/links	Scrollable text browser
Image	I	PNG, JPG, GIF, WebP, SVG	Scaled image + resize grip
Movie	M	MP4, MOV, AVI, MKV	Video player + seek timeline
Audio	A	MP3, WAV, AAC, FLAC	RMS waveform + playback controls
Document	D	PDF (via Qt PDF)	Scrollable PDF viewer
Paint	P	Embedded pixel canvas	Resizable paint canvas
Dot	Q	Connection pass-through	—

Inline viewers open with ↓ / close with ↑. Shift+↓ expands all selected nodes.

Technology

Component	Technology
Language	Python 3.9–3.12
UI Framework	PyQt6 (Qt6) — QGraphicsScene/View canvas
Media Playback	Qt Multimedia + FFmpeg (bundled)
PDF Viewing	QtPdf / QtPdfWidgets
Packaging	PyInstaller 6.x — single binary per platform
File Format	JSON (.flow) — human-readable, forward-compatible

Build & Distribution

Platform	Command	Output
macOS	./build_mac.sh	theFlow.app + theFlow-0.1.0.dmg
Windows	build_windows.bat	theFlow.exe + theFlow-0.1.0-setup.exe
Linux DEB	./build_deb.sh	theflow + theflow_0.1.0_amd64.deb
Linux RPM	./build_rpm.sh	theflow + theflow-0.1.0-1.x86_64.rpm
Linux Appliance	./build_appliance.sh	theflow + theFlow-0.1.0-x86_64.Appliance

Double-clicking a .flow file opens theFlow! on all platforms — file association is registered by the installer on Windows/Linux (DEB/RPM) and declared in Info.plist on macOS. The Appliance requires manual file association setup.

Key Shortcuts

Key	Action	Key	Action
T	Text node	Ctrl+Z	Undo
I	Image node	Ctrl+Y	Redo
M	Movie node	Ctrl+S	Save
A	Audio node	Ctrl+O	Open
D	Document node	Ctrl+N	New
B	Backdrop	F	Frame selected
S	Sticky note	Z	Frame all
Tab	Creation menu	K	Shortcuts help
↓ / ↑	Expand/close viewer	Shift+↓/↑	Expand/close all